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Honourable Jason Nixon
Minister of Assisted Living and Social Services
227 Legislature Building 10800 - 97 Ave
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RE: Request for Planned Actions and Formal Response on Outstanding Long-Term Care Issues

Seniors United Now (SUN) is writing to seek clarity on the planned actions your office intends to take to address the following outstanding issues in the long-term care system as identified in the report of the Auditor General 2014.

- No clear articulation of expected long-term care system outcomes.
What are the outcomes you are trying to achieve, and how will they be measured?
- No public reporting on system performance or progress toward outcomes.
Will you commit to providing outcomes in the future?

Annual reports now contain less long-term care information than in 2014. Work completed in 2018 to identify performance measures was not translated into public reporting. Reliance on external data sources does not replace the need for provincial accountability.

We also wish to reiterate the serious consequences of inaction in these areas, specifically:

- Continued risk to resident safety and quality of care.
- Reduced transparency and weakened public trust.
- Inability to assess whether the long-term care system is achieving intended outcomes.
- Limited accountability for more than \$2 billion in annual long-term care expenditures.

In light of these consequences, we respectfully request a formal response addressing each of the following points:

- What measures will be implemented to mitigate the continued risk to resident safety and quality of care?
- How will transparency be improved to restore and strengthen public trust?
- What steps will be taken to enable assessment of whether the long-term care system is achieving its intended outcomes?
- How will accountability be ensured for the significant public expenditures in long-term care?

We look forward to your detailed response and to working collaboratively to improve the service at long term care facilities for seniors.

Sincerely,
Wayne Sorenson
President, Seniors United Now

CC:
Lori Sigurdson - Shadow Minister for Seniors, Continuing Care and Homecare
Edmonton.Riverview@assembly.ab.ca

Peter Guthrie Airdire-Cochrane MLA

